

Email Workbench

User Manual

Version 3.0

Direct, powerful control over Microsoft Outlook — no cloud accounts, no Azure registrations, no subscriptions.

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1. Welcome

Email Workbench is a Windows desktop app that connects directly to Microsoft Outlook over MAPI/COM. There's no Azure app registration, no API keys, and no browser sign-in — it talks straight to the same Outlook already running on your machine.

This manual covers all 30 features across the app's six navigation groups: **Inbox**, **Compose**, **Cleanup Email**, **Contacts**, **Calendar**, and **Utilities** — plus Settings, About, and the system tray.

> New in v2.1: **Account Archive** (Inbox), and **Calendar Backup**, **Meeting Inspector**, and **Meeting Organizer Recovery** (Calendar) — look for the “New in v2.1” tag on those sections. Version 2.2 refines Meeting Organizer Recovery's detection and adds a Browse All Meetings fallback (see that section), plus several fixes found in real-world use. Version 2.3 makes startup feel faster (background tab pre-building plus a cached account/folder scan) and adds a Rescan / Refresh Connection button on the Welcome page. Version 2.4 adds single-instance protection, a --quit-for-update command for safely updating the app while it's running, and an optional Run at Windows startup setting so automation survives an unattended reboot. Version 2.5 fixes a startup visual glitch, adds an All Folders (Entire Account) option to Folder Statistics, fixes Account Archive missing subfolders of filed sent mail, and adds an Archive Now option that skips the preview step. Version 2.6 moves Folder Statistics into the Cleanup Email group, next to Email Size. Version 3.0 rebrands the app as **Email Workbench** with a refreshed look, and adds a new **Attachment Router** feature to Inbox — see Version History for the complete list.

Requirements

Operating system	Windows 10 or 11
Microsoft Outlook	Installed and running on the same machine
Internet access	Only needed for Bulk Email's Auto-Unsubscribe feature
Account types	Exchange / Microsoft 365 for full functionality; IMAP/POP3 accounts work for most features, with a few exceptions noted per feature below (e.g. Out of Office)

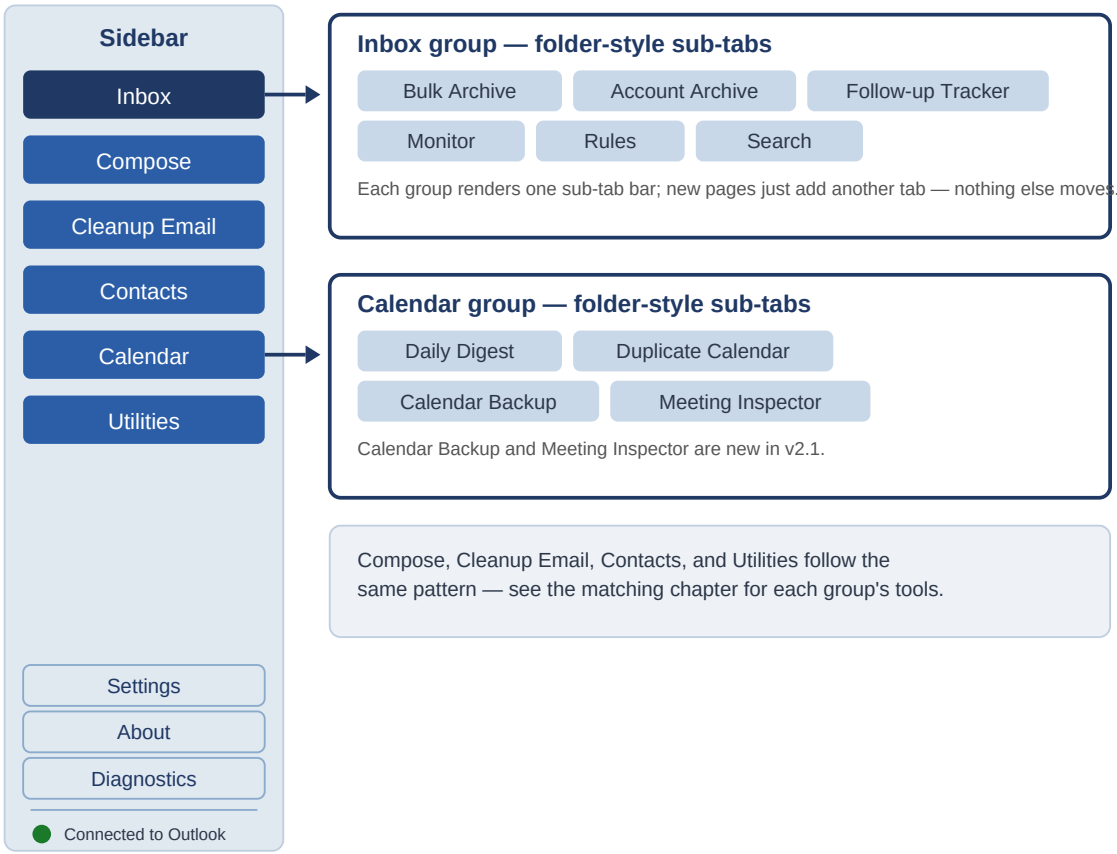
2. Getting Started

First Launch

- Open **Microsoft Outlook** first — the app connects to whichever Outlook profile is already running.
- Launch **Email Workbench.exe**. The window opens immediately and lands on a Welcome screen.
- A status line on the Welcome screen reads “Please wait while we fully connect to Microsoft Outlook…” while the app discovers every account and folder in your Outlook profile and pre-builds every other tab in the background, then switches to “✔ Done” — this can take a few seconds on large mailboxes the first time, but is usually much quicker on later launches since the previous scan is cached and reused while a fresh one catches up silently.
- A ■ **Rescan / Refresh Connection** button on the Welcome screen forces a full re-scan of every connected account and folder on demand — use it after adding a new Outlook account/profile, or any time the account/folder lists elsewhere in the app look out of date.
- Pick a group from the sidebar on the left to get started. Settings save automatically as you work.

Navigating the App

The sidebar has six grouped sections. Each group opens a row of folder-style sub-tabs across the top of the content area — clicking a tab swaps the page below it without leaving the group. Settings, About, and Diagnostics are pinned at the bottom of the sidebar and are not part of any group, with a live Outlook connection indicator beneath them.



The grouped sidebar navigation, showing the Inbox and Calendar groups' sub-tabs as an example.

The chapters that follow are organized the same way — one chapter per sidebar group, one section per sub-tab.

3. Inbox

Watch folders, track unanswered mail, clean up old email, archive an entire account, search, and manage native Outlook rules.

3.1 Monitor

Watches up to 4 Outlook folders at once, each with its own independent alert settings. If a watched folder goes quiet for longer than its threshold, the app fires an alert.

Account / Folder	Which mailbox and folder to watch
Alert if no mail for	Minutes of silence before an alert fires
Alert sound	20 built-in sounds, a Windows system sound, or a custom .wav
Repeat alert	Repeat the sound + popup every 1–5 minutes until mail arrives

Tip: Alerts use a real, dismissable popup window (not the Windows toast), so you can read the full message and select its text.

3.2 Follow-up Tracker

Scans Sent Items for messages that haven't received a reply after a configurable number of days, matching replies by conversation topic. Results export to .csv, and scans can run on a schedule (interval or daily at a set time).

Matching is best-effort — unusual threading across different mail clients can occasionally produce a false positive.

3.3 Bulk Archive

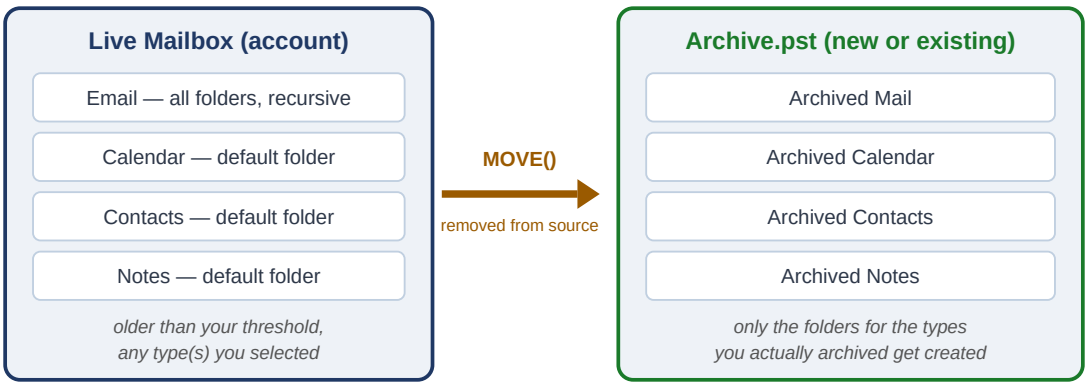
Moves or deletes many emails at once from a single folder, filtered by age (and optionally unread-only). A count preview always appears before anything happens.

Source folder	The one folder this scan targets
Action	Move to another Outlook folder, or Delete
Older than	Age threshold in days

3.4 Account Archive

New in v2.1

Moves old items out of an **entire account** into a separate .pst archive file — this actually frees up mailbox space, the same way Outlook's own built-in Archive works. Unlike Bulk Archive above (one folder, email only), Account Archive can sweep Email, Calendar, Contacts, and Notes in a single pass, with one age threshold for everything. Mail is matched on either its received or sent date, so folders filled with filed sent mail — which never has a received date — are archived correctly rather than being skipped.



Scan → preview → Confirm Archive, or skip straight to Archive Now — no preview.

Account Archive moves matched items out of the live mailbox into a new-or-existing .pst — the Scan button always goes through a Scan-then-Confirm review step; Archive Now (new in v2.5, see below) skips it.

How to use it

- Pick the **account** to archive — there's no folder picker here, since it works across the whole account.
- Check any combination of **Email, Calendar, Contacts, Notes**.
- Set the age threshold — one number applies to every checked type.
- Choose **Create new archive file** or **Add to an existing archive file** (the existing file just keeps growing across runs).
- Click **Scan**. A per-type count preview opens in a review window — uncheck any type you don't want archived this run, then click **Confirm Archive**.

Important: Calendar items that belong to an ongoing recurring series (no end date, or an end date in the future) are always skipped, even if older than your threshold — archiving would otherwise remove part of a meeting series you're still using.

Note: This is destructive by design — matched items are moved (not copied) out of their original folders. Use Calendar Backup instead if you want a copy that leaves the original untouched.

Archive Now (skip the preview)

New in v2.5

A second button, next to Scan, for when you don't want the review step. **Archive Now** scans using the exact same account/type/age settings above, then immediately moves every matching item into the archive file — no count preview, no confirmation window. The regular Scan → review → Confirm Archive flow described above is unchanged and still available; Archive Now is simply a faster alternative once you trust the settings you've chosen.

> **Note:** Because there's no review step, double-check the account, item types, and age threshold before clicking Archive Now — there's no chance to deselect anything once it starts.

3.5 Attachment Router

New in v3.0

Watches up to 10 Outlook folders at once — each gets its own card — and routes every attachment each one receives into a subject-named folder on a network drive (a mapped drive letter or a UNC path), then moves the email itself into that card's Processed folder. A later reply or forward on the same email adds its attachments into that same network folder instead of creating a new one — so a whole back-and-forth thread ends up filed together automatically.

Account / Watch folder	Which mailbox and folder to monitor for new mail (one per card)
Processed folder	Type a sub-folder name to auto-create it under the watch folder, or click Pick Folder… to choose any existing Outlook folder instead
Network drive folder	Where subject-named folders are created — a mapped drive or a UNC path
Check every (sec)	How often the watched folders are checked for new mail — shared across every card
Combine into Master PDF	Optionally also builds one growing PDF per subject, alongside the raw files — each card has its own on/off toggle

How it matches a reply to the right folder

- First, by Outlook's own **ConversationID** — the most reliable signal, since it survives a changed or shortened subject line.
- If that's not available yet (for example, right after the app restarts), it falls back to the **subject with RE:/FW:/FWD: prefixes stripped**, matched against the names of folders already on the network drive.
- If neither matches anything existing, a brand-new folder is created, named after the subject.

> **Tip:** Raw attachment files are always saved, whether or not the Master PDF option is on — the combined PDF is an extra, not a replacement. A repeated attachment filename on a later email is saved alongside the earlier one (never silently overwritten).

About the Master PDF: When Master PDF is on, Word/Excel/PowerPoint attachments get a real content preview (via the same Office app installed on this machine, run hidden in the background) — everything else, and anything that fails to convert, gets a plain placeholder page instead, naming the file. The original attachment is always saved either way, so nothing is ever lost to a failed preview.

3.6 Rules

A native Outlook Rules Manager — import, edit, create, and push rules directly back to Outlook. Rules saved here keep running in Outlook even when this app is closed.

- Select an account and click **Get Rules from Outlook**.
- Toggle rules on/off, delete unwanted ones, or add/edit rules.
- Click **Send to Outlook** — the entire remaining rule list is written back and saved; you don't need to select rules first.

If something goes wrong: If saving fails because a rule has an invalid condition or a missing target folder, the app identifies exactly which rules are the problem, shows the reason for each, and offers to remove the bad ones so the save can proceed.

3.7 Search

Full-text search across Subject, Sender, and Body — scoped to one folder or an entire account, with timestamped results and a Stop button for long searches.

4. Compose

Reusable email templates, automatic out-of-office replies, and signature management.

4.1 Templates

Save frequently-used email templates (name, subject, body). Opening a template pre-fills a new Outlook compose window with one click, with a signature picker built in.

4.2 Out of Office

Reads and writes your Exchange/Microsoft 365 auto-reply settings directly — internal and external messages, optional start/end dates, and an external audience control (all senders, or contacts only). Settings are sent straight to Outlook, so the app does not need to stay open for OOF to keep working.

> Requires an Exchange or Microsoft 365 account. IMAP/POP3 accounts show a warning — Outlook COM doesn't expose OOF for those account types.

4.3 Signatures

A launcher, not a WYSIWYG editor — Outlook signatures are Word-generated HTML with table layouts that a simple text editor can't reproduce faithfully. This page lists your existing signatures, previews them exactly as they'll render (images included), and opens them in Word for actual editing.

5. Cleanup Email

Detect bulk mail, find duplicate messages, and analyze mailbox and folder size.

5.1 Bulk Email

Two ways to find bulk senders:

- **Auto-detect** — flags a sender once they've been seen at least N times (configurable), or if their mail carries a List-Unsubscribe header. External senders only, by default.
- **Manual search** — From and/or Subject contains text you specify.

Action on matches	Log only / Flag / Move to folder / Delete
Excluded Domains	Domains that are never flagged, added via text entry or one click from scan results
Auto-Unsubscribe	One-click method where supported; opens a pre-filled Outlook draft for email-based unsubscribes

5.2 Duplicate Emails

Finds duplicate messages using configurable match criteria — Subject+Sender+Date, Subject+Sender, or a custom combination of Subject/Sender/Date/Body. Actions: Log only, Flag, Delete, or Export. Scans can run on a schedule.

5.3 Email Size

Lists the largest emails in a folder by size, to help you find what's actually consuming mailbox space.

5.4 Folder Statistics

Moved here in v2.6

An at-a-glance summary of any folder: total emails, unread count and percentage, total size in MB, oldest/newest email dates, and date span. Walks subfolders recursively, with Exchange cached-mode detection so you know whether the count reflects everything on the server or just what's cached locally.

New in v2.5: the Folder dropdown's first entry, **All Folders (Entire Account)**, scans every folder in the account in one pass — the results list each folder's own size alongside a combined account-wide total, instead of having to scan one folder at a time. Picking this option always includes subfolders (the checkbox locks on and greys out to show why); pick a specific folder instead to go back to the usual single-folder view with subfolders optional.

6. Contacts

Find and merge duplicate contacts; export or import via CSV.

6.1 Duplicate Contacts

Finds duplicates two ways — same name with different emails, and same email with different names.

- **Delete review** — every group listed with checkboxes (pre-checked for duplicates, keeper unchecked); nothing changes until you confirm.
- **Merge review** — choose a strategy per group: Most recently modified, Most complete, or Manual field-by-field with a live preview.

6.2 Export / Import

Exports contacts to .csv with selectable fields (Select All / Deselect All). Imports contacts from a .csv into any Contacts folder.

7. Calendar

Daily mail digest, duplicate meeting detection, calendar backup, and a diagnostic tool for meetings that won't stay deleted.

7.1 Daily Digest

Pick an account and folders to get unread counts, top senders, and sample subjects for each. Runs on demand, or as a daily popup at a set time.

7.2 Duplicate Calendar

Detects duplicate meetings two ways:

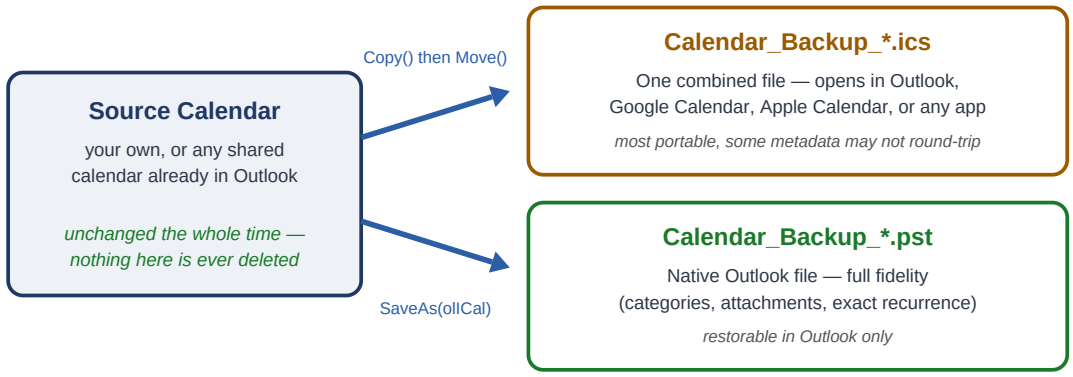
- **Individual occurrences** — finds duplicate instances within a configurable date range.
- **Recurring series** — compares entire series masters; choose whether to keep the older or newer master.

> Deleting a master in series mode removes every past and future occurrence in that series. A review window always opens first.

7.3 Calendar Backup

New in v2.1

Exports a calendar to .ics and/or a standalone .pst file — a non-destructive copy; nothing is ever removed from the original calendar. Works on your own calendar or any shared calendar already visible in your Outlook profile.



Calendar Backup can produce both output formats from the same run — the source calendar is only ever read from, never modified.

Scope

- **Entire calendar** — exports each recurring series once, as its master record with the recurrence pattern intact. Recommended for a full backup.
- **Date range** — expands recurring meetings into the individual occurrences that actually fall inside the window, which is closer to “what's on the calendar between these two dates.”

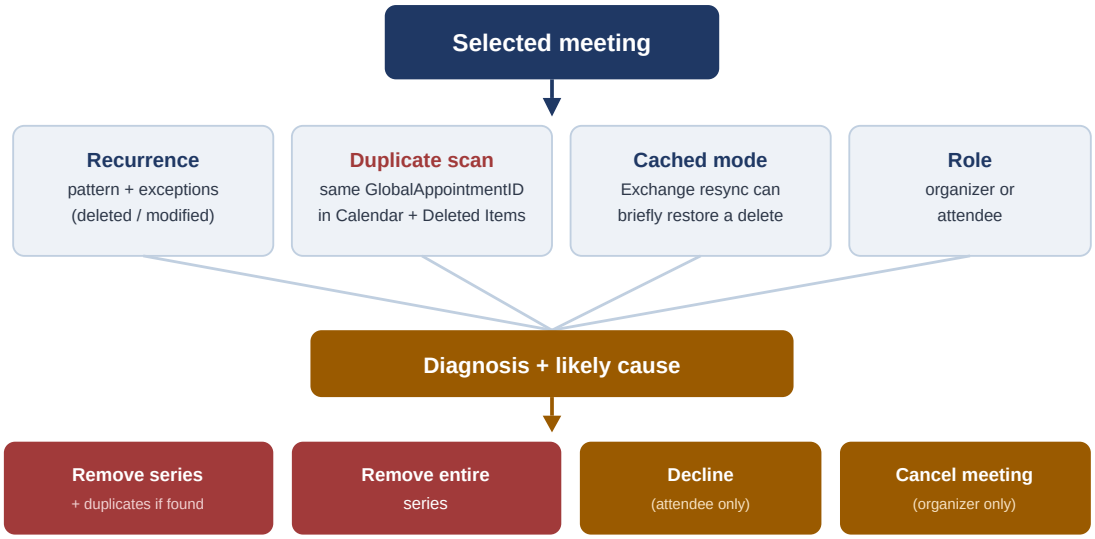
Output format

- **.ics** — one combined file, opens in Outlook, Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, or any calendar app. Most portable; some Outlook-specific metadata may not round-trip perfectly.
- **.pst** — a native Outlook data file, full fidelity (categories, attachments, exact recurrence). Restorable in Outlook only.

7.4 Meeting Inspector

New in v2.1

Diagnoses why a meeting keeps reappearing after you delete it, then helps you remove it the right way instead of guessing. This is the tool to reach for when a meeting comes back within minutes of deleting it, with no new invite email — that pattern usually means a duplicate copy or a sync quirk, not anything you did wrong.



Only the actions that fit what was found are shown — each requires a confirmation step.

Meeting Inspector runs four checks, then only offers the actions that fit what it actually found.

How to use it

- Pick an account and calendar folder, then click **Find**. The subject field is an optional filter — type part of the meeting's subject to narrow a long list, or leave it blank to list every meeting in that folder.
- Click **Inspect** on the match you mean. The Diagnosis panel fills in with the recurrence pattern, any exceptions, a duplicate-copy check, Cached Exchange Mode status, and whether you're the organizer or an attendee.

- Choose from the action buttons that appear below the diagnosis — only the ones that make sense for that meeting are shown.

What each check means

Recurrence pattern	Frequency, interval, end date, and how many exceptions (deleted or modified occurrences) exist on the series
Duplicate scan	Looks for another item with the same GlobalAppointmentID in the calendar and in Deleted Items — the direct explanation for “I deleted it and it came right back”
Cached Exchange Mode	If your mailbox is cached, a background resync can briefly re-show an item before the delete finishes syncing to the server
Organizer / Attendee	Determines whether Decline (attendee) or Cancel (organizer) is offered — deleting your own copy of someone else's meeting doesn't stop them resending it

Available actions

- **Remove series + duplicates** — shown only when a duplicate was found; removes the series and every duplicate copy detected.
- **Remove entire series** — deletes the master and every occurrence, past and future.
- **Decline meeting** — attendees only. Notifies the organizer, which is what actually prevents the meeting from being resent to you.
- **Cancel meeting** — organizers only. Notifies every attendee before removing it.

> **Note:** Every action here is permanent once confirmed. A confirmation step always appears first, describing exactly what will be removed.

Looking for a meeting still showing an old organizer after a calendar backup/restore into a different account? That's a separate diagnosis — see Meeting Organizer Recovery, next.

7.5 Meeting Organizer Recovery

New in v2.1

What it's for: a narrow, specific scenario — a mailbox was rebuilt, migrated, or had its calendar backed up and restored into a different account (for example after a corrupted profile), and meetings that mailbox used to organize are now stuck showing that old, no-longer-valid organizer identity. Outlook has no built-in way to reassign a meeting's organizer after the fact — Meeting Organizer Recovery works around that by recreating each affected meeting fresh, under the current account, rather than trying to edit the old one in place.

It has its own tab, right next to Meeting Inspector in the Calendar section (they're related but separate diagnoses, so each got room to breathe). Pick an account and calendar folder there, then scan — it finds that exact pattern in the folder selected and recreates each match as a fresh meeting organized by the current account.

How it decides what qualifies

- Only items this account's own calendar data still marks as organizer-type are considered — meetings you were only ever invited to are never touched.
- The meeting (or, for a series, its recurrence end date) must still be upcoming.
- To tell whether the stored organizer is actually stale, the scan first tries to resolve the meeting's organizer to a real mailbox address and compares that against the current account's own address — this catches the case that matters most for this feature: the same person, with the same display name, now on a rebuilt or migrated mailbox. Comparing names alone would miss that, since the display name can be identical on both the old and new mailbox. If a mailbox address can't be resolved for either side, it falls back to comparing organizer name against account name.
- Each match shows its subject, stale organizer name (and resolved address, when one was found), start time, whether it's a series, whether it looks like a Teams meeting, and attendee count, so you can select exactly which ones to recreate.

Browse All Meetings

The scan above is deliberately narrow, and it can come back with nothing even when a meeting really is showing a stale organizer — for example if the address-resolution step above can't reach a mailbox address for either the old or new account, and the two accounts happen to share a display name. When that happens, use **Browse All Meetings**, further down the same tab: it lists every upcoming meeting the selected account's data marks as organizer-type — matching the automatic pattern or not — so you can find and select the one you know isn't right, yourself. An optional "Organizer contains" field narrows a long list by organizer name or resolved address; leave it blank to see everything. Selected meetings go through the exact same recreate flow described above.

What “Recreate” actually does

- Builds a brand-new appointment on the current account with the same subject, location, time, reminder, body, recurrence pattern, and attendee list, then sends it.
- **Non-Teams meetings** are sent automatically once confirmed.

- **Teams meetings** are opened as a draft for you to review and send manually instead, because a genuine new Teams online-meeting link can't be reliably generated from this app alone — it needs the Teams add-in's own provisioning step, which only runs when you send from an open Outlook compose window.
- The stale local copy is always deleted afterward. If the old account is also still connected in this same Outlook profile, its live copy of the meeting is cancelled first so its attendees get a proper cancellation notice rather than an orphaned duplicate.

Note: Recreating sends a new invite to the same recipients. Anyone who already has the original meeting will end up with two copies on their calendar unless the original can also be cancelled — which this app can only do if the old account is still connected here. If it isn't (the usual case after the old account has been fully decommissioned), have whoever manages your Exchange/365 tenant run the **Remove-CalendarEvents** PowerShell cmdlet against the old mailbox instead — that's Microsoft's supported way to cancel, on every remaining attendee's calendar, every meeting that mailbox organized. It's the correct complement to this feature, not something this app can do itself: cancelling on behalf of an account requires Exchange admin permissions this app deliberately never asks for.

Admin command to clear the old mailbox's meetings

Run in Exchange Online PowerShell (connect first with `Connect-ExchangeOnline`), substituting the old mailbox's email address or account name:

```
Remove-CalendarEvents -Identity "old.mailbox@yourdomain.com"
-CancelOrganizedMeetings
```

- **-Identity** — the old/departing mailbox whose meetings need cancelling (email address, alias, or display name).
- **-CancelOrganizedMeetings** — sends a cancellation, on that mailbox's behalf, to every attendee for every meeting it organized. Without this switch the cmdlet only removes items from the mailbox's own calendar and does not notify anyone else.
- Add **-QueryStartDate** / **-QueryWindowInDays** to limit the sweep to a date range instead of the default, and **-WhatIf** first to preview what would be cancelled without actually sending anything.

Full syntax, all parameters, and permission requirements: learn.microsoft.com — Remove-CalendarEvents.

8. Utilities

Extract attachments, export emails to PDF, review the event log, and schedule automation.

8.1 Attachments

Extracts attachments from any Outlook folder to a local path or another Outlook folder, with an option to move processed emails afterward. Attachments are saved into sub-folders named after each email's subject.

8.2 Export to PDF

Exports individual emails or entire folders to PDF — one PDF per email.

Scope	All emails in folder, or a date range (calendar picker included)
Additional filter	Subject or From contains text — applies regardless of scope, with a red “Filter Active” badge when set
Options	List attachment names, save attachments to a subfolder, choose filename format, open the output folder when done

8.3 Log

A live, timestamped record of every event — monitor checks, alerts, extractions, rule actions, scans, and errors. Exportable to .txt or .csv.

8.4 Schedule

Runs attachment extraction automatically on an interval and/or daily at a set time, using the same source/destination settings as the Attachments tab.

9. Settings & About

Appearance	Dark, Light (default), or System
On window close	Auto (default — asks only if Monitor is active), Ask, Tray, or Exit
Portable Version	Off (default), or On — wipes every other saved setting when the app closes (the toggle itself stays on, so it only needs to be checked once), so running this app from a USB drive or shared folder on a different computer never inherits the previous computer's accounts, folders, or settings.
Run at Windows startup	Off (default), or On — launches automatically, minimized to the tray, the next time you log in. See Reliability: Updates and Reboots below. Switches itself back off whenever Portable Version is on, so a USB/portable install never leaves a startup entry pointing at a drive that may not be there next time.

The About page shows the full feature list, version number, third-party library attributions, and the complete proprietary license text — and includes a suggestion box that emails the developer directly.

Reliability: Updates and Reboots

New in v2.4 — If Inbox Monitor or any scheduled automation (Follow-up Tracker, Daily Digest, a duplicate scan, or Scheduled Extraction) is running and the window is just minimized to the tray, the app is still very much running and still holds its own files open.

- **Updating the app while it's running** used to be able to fail, because a plain window-close is deliberately treated as “minimize to tray” rather than “exit” under the On window close setting above — so the process never actually went away and its files stayed locked. The app now refuses to let a second copy run at the same time (launching it again while it's already open just brings the existing window to the front), and supports a command-line flag an installer or update script can run right before it replaces this app's files: `“Email Workbench.exe” --quit-for-update` — it reliably closes a running copy, even one minimized in the tray with automation active, and returns once it's confirmed gone (or immediately if none was running).
- **An unattended reboot** (e.g. a Windows Update installing overnight) used to leave the app simply not running afterward, silently stranding every scheduled task until someone remembered to reopen it. Turning on **Run at Windows startup** above closes that gap — the app relaunches automatically, minimized to the tray, the next time you log in.

Outlook Connection Status

New in v2.1 — A small dot and status label sit at the bottom of the sidebar, just below Settings, About, and Diagnostics, showing whether the app is currently talking to Outlook.

● **Green — “Connected to Outlook”**	Outlook is running and reachable; every tool is available.
● **Red — “Outlook not running”**	Outlook isn't currently running, or has closed — features that need Outlook will not work until it's open again.

Auto-reconnect: The app checks Outlook's status automatically every few seconds — you never need to click anything or restart the app. If Outlook isn't running when the app starts, or closes while the app is open, the dot turns red, a note is written to the Log tab, and (if Outlook closes mid-session) a Windows notification lets you know. As soon as Outlook is running again, the dot turns green on its own and the app automatically refreshes its list of accounts and folders — no restart needed either way.

Diagnostics

New in v2.1 — The connection light only proves Outlook itself is running; it says nothing about whether one specific account's data is actually loading. A corrupted local cache (.ost) or a stuck sync can leave an account showing “connected” while its folders never populate. Diagnostics (bottom of the sidebar, next to Settings and About) checks every account directly and tells you exactly what's wrong.

Diagnostics is split into three sub-tabs — **Accounts**, **Add-ins**, and **System** — each checking a different layer of what can go wrong.

Accounts

It checks the same set of accounts shown on every other page's account dropdown — including any shared mailboxes or public folders you've been given access to, not just your own accounts. Results are grouped under two headings, **Configured Accounts** and **Shared / Delegated Accounts**, so it's obvious at a glance which is which.

Click **Run Diagnostic** and the app checks each account's ability to actually enumerate its own folders (with an 8-second timeout per account, so one stuck account can't freeze the check), along with its Cached Exchange Mode status and the health of its local data file. Each account is marked OK, Warning, or Failed, with the specific reason and — for local data files — the exact file path. Where available, each card also shows a **Send/Receive Activity** summary (how long since each Send/Receive group last synced), a **mailbox quota** reading on Exchange/Microsoft 365 accounts once it's within 90% of full, and a warning if the account's data file lives inside a OneDrive/Dropbox/Google Drive/iCloud-synced folder — Microsoft advises against this, since the sync client can lock or partially write the file while Outlook has it open.

Close Outlook & Repair	Offered only for server-backed accounts (Exchange cached mode, or an IMAP .ost) — closes Outlook, renames the local cache so Outlook rebuilds it fresh from the server, then reopens Outlook automatically. Closing and renaming takes up to about 30 seconds, with live progress shown on the Diagnostics tab; the resync afterward is separate and can take much longer on a large mailbox. Not offered for a plain .pst, since that file is the only copy of that data.
Point to a backup file…	Browse to any .pst and mount it as a stand-in Outlook data source, so you have working data while the live account gets fixed. You choose each time whether the mount stays permanently or is removed automatically when the app closes.

> **If automated repair doesn't work:** If Close Outlook & Repair can't finish — Outlook won't close, or the cache file stays locked — a popup walks you through what to try next: confirm Outlook is fully closed (check Task Manager) and retry, run the Inbox Repair Tool (SCANPST.EXE) on the file, or remove and re-add the account in Outlook's Account Settings. The same popup reminds you that Point to a backup file… is there in the meantime.

Diagnostics can't repair server-side Microsoft 365 issues, and closing/renaming only clears out the local cache — anything that existed solely in that file and never finished syncing to the server (an unsent draft, for example) could be lost, so the confirmation step calls that out before anything happens.

Add-ins

Lists every COM add-in registered in Outlook, whether it's currently loaded, and its startup setting (loads at startup, loads on demand, or disabled). A misbehaving add-in is a common cause of a slow, hanging, or oddly-behaving Outlook session even when every account above checks out fine.

Enable / Disable	Toggling an add-in unloads or reloads it immediately in the running Outlook session and updates its startup setting in the registry, matching Outlook's own File > Options > Add-ins dialog. If a disabled add-in re-enables itself after a restart, an organization IT policy is likely re-enforcing it and it can't be controlled from here.
Crash alert	A banner appears if Outlook has recently auto-disabled an add-in after it crashed — a likely explanation for any add-in below unexpectedly showing “Not loaded.”

System

Two machine-level checks that commonly explain Outlook trouble which has nothing to do with any specific account:

Duplicate Outlook processes	Flags more than one OUTLOOK.EXE process running at once — a leftover process from a previous crash can lock data files and cause exactly the kind of “connected but broken” behavior Diagnostics exists to catch.
Disk space	Checks free space on every drive that hosts an account's local data file, and warns when a drive is low — cache growth failures and corruption both become more likely as free space runs out.

10. System Tray

Closing the main window asks what to do, based on the Settings page above.

Minimize to Tray	Window hides; monitoring and scheduling keep running
Exit	App shuts down completely

Double-click the tray icon, or click Show, to restore the window; Quit exits fully.

11. Security

The compiled executable includes tamper/decompilation detection. If the app detects it's being run outside its compiled environment, a full-screen warning displays the machine name, IP address, and timestamp before terminating. Reverse-engineering or decompiling this software is prohibited under the license agreement (see Section 13).

12. Troubleshooting

“Cannot connect to Outlook”

Open Outlook before launching this app. If Outlook just opened, wait a few seconds and try again.

Folders not populating in the dropdowns

Check the Log tab — any connection errors appear there with details.

pywin32 errors during build

build.bat runs the post-install step automatically. If issues persist, run manually: python Scripts\pywin32_postinstall.py -install

Tray icon not appearing

Make sure Pillow and pystray are installed: pip install Pillow pystray

Out of Office not working

OOF requires an Exchange or Microsoft 365 account. IMAP/POP3 accounts don't support Out of Office via Outlook COM — the app shows a warning on that page if your account type isn't compatible.

Rules “invalid actions or conditions” error on save

One or more existing Outlook rules may have a missing target folder or invalid condition. The app identifies the specific rules and offers to remove them automatically so the save can proceed.

Bulk Email auto-detect not flagging anything

On personal accounts, the app may not detect your “own domain” automatically — check the Log tab for a note. Frequency-based and List-Unsubscribe detection still work; double-check your Excluded Domains list isn't covering senders you expected to see.

Auto-Unsubscribe not working for a sender

Some senders only support unsubscribing by email reply. The app opens a pre-filled Outlook draft rather than failing silently — check the results list for a [unsubscribe via email] tag.

A meeting keeps coming back after I delete it

Use the Meeting Inspector (Calendar group) instead of deleting it again — it will tell you whether this is a duplicate copy, a cached-mode resync, or an attendee/organizer mismatch, and offer the action that actually fixes it.

Account Archive says an account isn't found

The account name must match exactly what Outlook shows for that store. Re-open the page to refresh the account dropdown if you've recently added or removed an account in Outlook.

The dot below About is red

The app can't currently reach Outlook — usually because Outlook isn't open, or just closed. Open (or reopen) Outlook and wait a few seconds; the dot turns green and the app reconnects automatically, with no restart needed.

The dot is green, but one account's folders won't populate

That green light only confirms Outlook itself is running — it doesn't check any individual account. Open Diagnostics (bottom of the sidebar) and click Run Diagnostic; it will identify the broken account, explain the likely cause (usually a corrupted .ost or a stuck sync), and point you at the exact file and fix. You can also mount a backup .pst from there to keep working meanwhile.

A disabled add-in turns itself back on

Check the Add-ins sub-tab under Diagnostics. If it re-enables after an Outlook restart, your organization's IT policy is likely managing that add-in centrally — it can't be permanently disabled from a per-user setting in that case.

Diagnostics flags low disk space or a near-full mailbox

Both are shown on the Diagnostics tab (System and Accounts sub-tabs) before they cause real symptoms. Free up space on the flagged drive, or ask your admin about a mailbox quota increase or an archive/cleanup pass, before the account starts failing to sync.

Organizer Recovery recreated a meeting, but attendees now see two copies

That happens when the old organizing account isn't connected in this same Outlook profile anymore, so this app has no way to send a cancellation from it. Ask your Exchange/365 admin to run Remove-CalendarEvents against the old mailbox — that cancels, on every attendee's calendar, everything it organized, clearing out the duplicate.

13. Version History

v3.0

Renamed the app from Beeran's Outlook Tools to Email Workbench, with a new logo/icon and a refreshed, more modern look for the content pane (matching the lighter blue background used across the other Beeran apps) · added a new Attachment Router feature to Inbox: watches an Outlook folder, routes attachments into subject-named folders on a network drive, and moves the processed email into a Processed sub-folder — a later reply/forward on the same email adds to the same network folder instead of creating a new one; an optional Master PDF mode also combines every attachment for a subject into one growing PDF, with real content previews for Word/Excel/PowerPoint files · (still testing, same v3.0) Attachment Router now watches up to 10 folders at once instead of one, each with its own Pick Folder… button to choose an existing Outlook folder as the Processed destination instead of only typing a name, and its own Combine into Master PDF toggle (was one checkbox shared by every folder) · Monitor's folder limit raised from 4 to 10

v2.6

Fixed Folder Statistics' description text not wrapping to a second line — it was missing the wraplength every other page's description label uses, so it ran off the edge of the page instead of wrapping · moved Folder Statistics from the Utilities group to Cleanup Email, next to Email Size, since both analyze mailbox/folder size · fixed a pre-existing bug, found during a pre-build code review rather than reported, where the on-screen Log tab silently stopped receiving new entries (and Clear appeared to do nothing) a few seconds after every launch — a leftover duplicate registration of the Log page meant the background startup pre-builder built an invisible second copy that stole the app's one shared reference to the log textbox; exported logs were never affected, only the live view

v2.5

Fixed a startup visual glitch where pages/sub-tabs built in the background (see v2.3's pre-builder, below) briefly — or, for the last one built, permanently — flashed on top of the Welcome screen right after opening the app; a freshly-created page is stacked on top of its already-placed siblings by default, so each pre-built page is now explicitly lowered below its siblings the instant it's created and stays hidden until you actually navigate to it · Folder Statistics gained an “All Folders (Entire Account)” option, listed first in the Folder dropdown, that scans every folder in the account in one pass and reports each folder's own size alongside a combined account-wide total · Account Archive's “entire account” mode no longer silently skips subfolder trees made up mostly of filed sent mail — mail is now matched on received date OR sent date, since a composed/sent item never has a received date and previously never matched regardless of age — and any folder that fails to scan is now listed by name and reason instead of silently vanishing from the results along with everything under it · added a new “■ Archive Now” button next to Scan that scans and moves matching items immediately, with no preview or confirmation window, as a faster alternative to the existing Scan → review → Confirm Archive flow (unchanged)

v2.4

Single-instance protection: a second launch now brings the already-running copy to the front instead of opening a confusing duplicate (two copies both polling/moving the same mailbox would be a real problem) · new --quit-for-update command line flag lets an update process (an installer, or a manual update script) reliably close a running copy — even one sitting minimized in the tray with Inbox Monitor or a schedule

active — before replacing this app's files, instead of the update silently failing because a plain window-close is treated as minimize-to-tray whenever something would be lost by closing outright · new “Run at Windows startup, minimized to the tray” Settings checkbox, off by default, so Inbox Monitor and any scheduled automation (Follow-up Tracker, Daily Digest, duplicate scans, Scheduled Extraction) comes back on its own after an unattended reboot — e.g. a Windows Update installing overnight — instead of staying stranded until someone reopens the app by hand; self-heals the registry entry on every launch and disables itself automatically with Portable Version

v2.3

Faster perceived startup: right after the window opens, every tab and sub-tab is pre-built in small background chunks while the Welcome page shows “Please wait while we fully connect to Microsoft Outlook…”, so the first click on any tab is usually already instant instead of pausing to build that tab's widgets · the scanned Outlook account/folder list is now cached to config.json, so the next launch can pre-build tabs with real data immediately instead of waiting on that launch's own live Outlook scan — the live scan still always runs and silently refreshes everything once done · new “■ Rescan / Refresh Connection” button on the Welcome page forces a fresh full scan of every connected account/folder on demand and refreshes all tabs' dropdowns with the result, with its own working/done status message · the Welcome page now shows a live status line for both of the above, ending in a “✔ Done” message

v2.2

Fixes and refinements found testing the deployed v2.1 build. Meeting Organizer Recovery's detection now resolves each meeting's organizer (and the current account) to a real mailbox address rather than just comparing display names, so a same-name/rebuilt-mailbox case is caught correctly; added Browse All Meetings, a manual list-and-select fallback with an optional organizer filter, for when the automatic scan finds nothing · fixed a startup crash, and similar crashes from scheduled background scans (Daily Digest, Follow-up Tracker, duplicate email/contact scans, scheduled extraction), introduced by v2.1's lazy tab-loading speed-up, where the app could try to update a tab's contents before that tab had ever been opened that session · Meeting Inspector's subject field is now correctly optional, so Find with it left blank lists every meeting in the folder instead of refusing to search · the main window now reopens at the same size and screen position it was last closed at, instead of always resetting to a fixed centered size, and no longer renders oversized on a monitor running Windows display scaling above 100%

v2.1

Calendar Backup (.ics / .pst export, non-destructive) · Meeting Inspector (duplicate-copy and recurrence diagnostics) · Meeting Organizer Recovery (its own tab; recreates meetings left showing a stale organizer after a calendar backup/restore into a different or rebuilt account) · Account Archive (whole-account, multi-type, moves to a new-or-existing .pst) · Outlook connection status indicator with automatic reconnect · Diagnostics, now with Accounts / Add-ins / System sub-tabs — per-account health check with mailbox quota, Send/Receive activity, and cloud-sync data-file warnings, one-click repair for server-backed accounts, backup-file mount, COM add-in list with enable/disable, and system-level checks for duplicate Outlook processes and low disk space · Portable Version setting · build.bat now updates pip automatically before installing dependencies · faster startup and shutdown (pages now build on first visit instead of all at once) · exe/install folder name made version-less so future updates don't move the install path

v2.0

Native Outlook Rules Manager · Email Templates · Out of Office Manager · Bulk Archive · Email Size Analyzer · Folder Statistics · Contact Export/Import · Duplicate Calendar Detector · Grouped navigation · 20 built-in alert sounds · Tamper detection

v1.5

Follow-up Tracker · Daily Digest · Duplicate Email Detector · Duplicate Contact Detector · Bulk Email Detector with auto-unsubscribe · Welcome landing page

v1.4

4 built-in musical alert sounds · Per-folder repeat alerts

v1.3

Multi-folder monitor (up to 4) · Per-folder custom sounds · About page · Light mode default

v1.2

System tray · Scheduled extraction · Email rules engine · Full-text search · Log export · Dark/light themes

v1.0

Inbox monitor · Attachment extractor · In-app log · Windows notifications

14. License & Support

Email Workbench is proprietary software — free to use, but may not be modified or redistributed. Attempting to reverse-engineer or decompile the application is prohibited under the license agreement. The complete license text is in LICENSE.md and on the About page inside the app.

Support & Suggestions

Use the About tab inside the app to send a suggestion directly, or email **BeeransTools@outlook.com**. This app grows with its users — if there's a feature, a folder action, or anything else on your mind, it's worth sending.

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